Vocabulary

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Overview

1. Loans as a map of the past
2. Building words: derivational morphology
3. Meaning differences between languages
4. Some cultural key words

Outline

1 Loans as a map of the past

2 Building words: derivational morphology

3 Meaning differences between languages

4 Some cultural key words

Loanwords Are a Map of Contact

- Every borrowed word records a **contact**: trade, religion, conquest, fashion
- Old loans blend in; new ones still look **foreign**
- Peel back the layers to read a language's **history**

This week follows Goddard (2005, Chapter 3).

Four Kinds of Loan

Kind	Example	Comment
indigenized	*gift*, *root*	so old nobody notices
prestige	*crown*, *judge*	high status, like the rulers' language
cultural	*coffee*, *sushi*	a new thing arrives
calque	*sky-scraper*	translate the parts: German *Wolken-kratzer* French *gratte-ciel*

English: Layer upon Layer

When	From	Examples
800s–900s	Old Norse	*take*, *get*, *want*, *die*, *low*
from 1066	Norman French	*crown*, *judge*, *court*, *army*
from 1400s	Latin, Greek	*scientific*, *describe*, *bonus*
1500s on	the world	*canoe*, *tomato*, *coffee*, *tsunami*

- Norse was close to Old English, so its words are now invisible
- Latin was the language of learning; printing spread its words

The Farmer's Animal, the Lord's Dinner

on the farm (English)	on the table (French)
cow	*beef*
sheep	*mutton*

After 1066 French was the rulers' language, English the people's: a **dual vocabulary** for formal and common use

Borrowed Parts Become Productive

ex- *ex-wife*

-able *readable* *googleable*

Learned words came from Latin and Greek, often by way of French, and brought affixes that now attach to anything

Words Travel by Indirect Routes

Word	From	Via
canoe, *potato*	Taíno	Spanish
tomato, *chocolate*	Nahuatl	Spanish
coffee	Arabic	Turkish
sushi, *tsunami*	Japanese	—

These loans mark new foods, objects and practices

Loans Can Change the Sound System

Old English *leaf* [f] *leaves* [v]

one phoneme /f/, two sounds

after French *fine* *vine*

two phonemes: /f/ ≠ /v/

French loans such as *veal* and *vine* made /v/ a phoneme

Malay: Religion Brought Words

Sanskrit, Pali	*rasa*	feel, taste
2nd c. BC on	*nama*	name
	guru	teacher
Arabic	*fikir*	think
with Islam, 1200s on	*ilmu*	knowledge
	waktu	time
	haram	forbidden

- Malay sits at the **crossroads** of India and China
- Indic loans are fully nativised; Arabic ones keep their fricatives and spellings like *kh*: *khabar* "news"

Malay: Trade and Empire Brought Words

Tamil	*kedai* “shop”, *katil* “bed”, *mangga* “mango”
Chinese	*teh* “tea”, *mi* “noodles”
Portuguese	*gereja* “church”, *garpu* “fork”, *almari* “cupboard”
Dutch	*senapang* “gun”, *pelakat* “placard”
English	*tiket* “ticket”, *kamera* “camera”

Regional trade first; European colonisers after the fall of Malacca in 1511

Different Colonisers, Different Loans

	Malaysia	Indonesia	
office	*ofis*	*kantor*	< Dutch *kantoor*
ticket	*tiket*	*karcis*	< Dutch *kaartjes*

Malay borrows from English (Britain), Indonesian from Dutch (the Netherlands)

Thai: Indic Words Are the Formal Register

	Native Thai	Indic
head	*hŭa*	*sĭisà'*
eye	*taa*	*phranêet*
dog	*măa*	*sunák*

- Burmese, Thai, Lao and Khmer took Sanskrit and Pali with Theravada Buddhism (and their scripts)
- New words are often **calques** on Indic roots: *thoola²*.*that¹* "television" [far.vision]
- European loans are rarer (though becoming common)

Chinese in Mainland Southeast Asia

Lao, from Chinese	
toq2	table
ngen2	money
bòò1	not

- Over 1,000 years of contact: Lao, Thai and Vietnamese
- Numbers and **classifiers** especially
- Strongest in Vietnamese, down to basic nouns and grammar

Chinese in Korea and Japan

釈迦	*Shaka*	Buddha
鉢	*hachi*	bowl
馬	*uma*	horse

- Borrowing begins in the first millennium AD, with Buddhism: traditionally 552 (*Nihon shoki*; 538 in other sources), from Paekche (in Korea)
- Script, religion and social norms came too

Japanese: Who Brought Which Words

When	From	Examples
mid-1500s	Portuguese	*tempura*
Edo	Dutch	*kokku* “cook”, *garasu* “glass”
Meiji on	French	*atorie* “studio”, *ankēto* “survey”
Meiji on	English	*terebi* “TV”, *sararii* “salary”

Japan was closed to all Europeans but the Dutch until 1854, so French loans are Meiji or later

Japanese Loans Today: Borrow, Then Rebuild

loan	*yogapantsu*	yoga pants
	beddo	Western-style bed
clipped	*rimōto*	remote working
hybrid	*ichigo-ēdo*	strawberry + “-ade”
	wan-man-kaa	one-man (driver-only) bus

Technology, fashion and popular culture borrow most

Return Loans: 和製漢語 *wasei-kango*

Meiji Japan built new words from **Chinese** morphemes for Western ideas; China, Korea and Vietnam borrowed them **back**

		Japanese	Mandarin	Vietnamese
科学/科学	science	*kagaku*	*kēxué*	*khoa học*
経済/经济	economy	*keizai*	*jīngjì*	*kinh tế*
社会/社会	society	*shakai*	*shèhuì*	*xã hội*

- New coinages: 哲学 *tetsugaku* “philosophy”, 電話 *denwa* “telephone”
- Old words with a new sense: 経済 < 経世済民 “govern the world, relieve the people”
- So a Sino-Japanese word need not be a loan from Chinese

Pseudo-Loans: Made at Home from Foreign Parts

		from
sararīman	office worker	*salary man*
konsento	power socket	*concentric plug*
haendeupon	mobile phone	*hand phone*
apateu	block of flats	*apartment*

Japanese *wasei-eigo* “English made in Japan”, and Konglish

The Traffic Runs Both Ways

English	from	
tycoon	Japanese 大君 *taikun*	great lord
ketchup	Hokkien *kê-tsiap* (via Malay)	fish brine
emoji	Japanese 絵文字 *emoji*	picture character
amok	Malay *amuk*	
orangutan	Malay *orang hutan*	forest person

emoji has nothing to do with *emotion*

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Three Ways to Build a Word

affixation	*un-reli-able*, *sad-ness*, *re-written*
compounding	*book-shop*, *black-board*
reduplication	*choo-choo*

- **Derivation** makes new words; **inflection** changes a word's form for grammar (tense, number)
- Sinitic and mainland Southeast Asian languages have almost no inflection; Japanese, Korean and Austronesian do
- Derivation is more common than inflection in many Asian languages

Compounding: The Main Way to Make Words

- Sinitic and mainland Southeast Asian languages rely on it
- Usually **two** elements: nouns, adjectives or verbs
- Productive, but the meaning is not always predictable

Mandarin Compounds

		literally	means
parallel	花木 *huā-mù*	flower-tree	vegetation
metaphor	狗熊 *gǒu-xióng*	dog-bear	bear
verb/adj.	痛苦 *tòng-kǔ*	painful-bitter	suffering
N_1 N_2	台灯 *tái-dēng*	table-lamp	desk lamp

Productive N_1 N_2 patterns: N_1 is the place, purpose or material of N_2

Japanese Compounds: Native, Sino-Japanese, Foreign

		literally	means
native	*aki-zora*	autumn-sky	autumn sky
S-J	*to-kei*	time-meter	clock
S-J	*shakai-gaku*	society-study	sociology
hybrid	*keshi-gomu*	erase-rubber	eraser

Compounding is the most productive way to make words in Japanese; Sino-Japanese compounds dominate technical vocabulary

Rendaku: The Second Part Voices

aki + *sora*	→	*aki-zora*	autumn sky
hito + *hito*	→	*hito-bito*	people
te + *kami*	→	*te-gami*	letter

Native compounds often voice the first consonant of the second element

Japanese Compound Verbs

	literally	means	
naguri-korosu	beat-kill	kill by beating	(manner)
kaki-ageru	write-raise	write up	(aspect)

Native and Sino-Japanese compounds order their parts differently: native OV *hon-yomi* “book-reading”, Sino-Japanese VO *doku-sho* “read-book”

Action, Doer or Tool

	literally	the action	also
hito-goroshi	person-kill	killing a person	a killer
ha-migaki	tooth-polish	brushing teeth	toothpaste

Compound meanings shift from action to agent, instrument or location

Japanese Loves Abbreviations

paasonaru konpyutaa	→	*paso-kon*	
tōkyō daigaku	→	*tō-dai*	
大阪大学 *ōsaka daigaku*	→	阪大 *han-dai*	not 大大!

- Long compounds are clipped to a preferred length
- Blends merge parts of different words
- Everywhere in the media and everyday speech

Reduplication: Say It Twice

Vietnamese	*đỏ* red	→	*đo đỏ* reddish
	trắng white	→	*trăng trắng* whitish
Indonesian	*lalat* fly	→	*lalat-lalat* flies

- Far more common in East and Southeast Asia than in English
- Attenuation, intensity, plurality; often partial, often with a sound change (here the reduplicant loses its tone)

Rhyming and Chiming

	Indonesian		English
rhyming	*kaya-raya*	rich	*lovey-dovey*
chiming	*teka-teki*	riddle	*zig-zag*
	bolak-balik	back and forth	*flip-flop*

Often idiomatic and expressive; extensive in Thai and Vietnamese too

Few Affixes in Sinitic and Mainland Southeast Asia

Cantonese	*gong2-faat3*	speak-way	way of saying
	jin6doi6-faa3	modern-ize	modernize
Thai	*kaan-lên*	NMLZ-play	playing
Vietnamese	*phản-kháng*	counter-resist	protest

- Many Vietnamese affixes are Chinese (*phản-* < 反); productive in journalism and academic writing
- Hakka marks gender with suffixes derived from kin terms

Malay: Productive Affixation

root		derived	
darat land	*meN-*	*men-darat*	go ashore
bersih clean	*meN- -kan*	*mem-bersih-kan*	to clean

Prefixes, suffixes and circumfixes: *meN-* makes dynamic verbs, *-kan* makes transitive ones

Korean and Japanese: Causative Suffixes

Korean	*bo-* see	*bo-i-*	show
Japanese	*mi-* see	*mi-sase-*	make someone look

Korean *-i* has several allomorphs; Japanese *-(s)ase* attaches to almost any verb

Summary: Who Uses Which Tool?

	compound	reduplicate	affix
Mandarin, Cantonese	●	◐	○
Thai, Vietnamese	●	●	◐
Japanese	●	◐	●
Korean	◐	◐	●
Malay, Indonesian	◐	●	●

Isolating languages compound; Austronesian, Japanese and Korean affix

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Some Words Have No Equivalent

お見合い	*omiai*	formal marriage meeting
酒	*sake*	any alcoholic drink
日本酒	*nihonshu*	“Japanese sake” — the rice wine

- English borrowed *sake* for the rice wine; in Japanese *sake* is any alcoholic drink, so English narrowed it
- Words for emotions, values and ideals differ; so do basic words

Describing Meaning: Polysemy

How can we describe it when we don't have it in our language?

- Define with **simpler** words, never circular or obscure ones
- **Polysemy**: one word, several related meanings
- Languages **group** meanings differently: compare the meanings, not just the words

Languages Carve Up Meanings Differently

English	Czech	Malay	Japanese	Mandarin	
nose	*nos*	*hidung*		*bízi*	of a person
trunk	*chobot*	*belalai*	*hana*		of an elephant
muzzle	*čenich*	*muncung*		*zuǐ*	of a dog
beak	*zobák*	*paruh*	*kuchibashi*		of a bird

English	Malay	
live	*hidup*	be alive
	tinggal	reside somewhere

The Syntax Can be Different

- Each meaning comes with its own **grammatical frame**
- English *live* "reside" needs a place: *live in Prague*
- Malay *buat*: *buat kuih* "make" vs *buat kerja* "do"
- Different arguments, different meanings

“Exist (There is)” and “Have”: Often One Word

(1) Ada dua ekor lembu.
exist two CLF cow
“There are two cows.” [zsm]

(2) Orang ini ada dua ekor lembu.
person this exist two CLF cow
“This person has two cows.” [zsm]

Malay *ada*, Mandarin *yǒu*: one argument means “there is”, two arguments mean “have”

Even Water Differs

English	Japanese	
water	水 *mizu*	cold or room temperature
	湯 *yu*	hot

atsui mizu “hot *mizu*” sounds odd: Japanese has no one word for all water

How Do Things Break?

Malay		**Japanese**	
putus	break in two	*oru*	break off
patah	break, not sever	*kowasu*	destroy
pecah	break into pieces	*kiru*	cut off

Cantonese also distinguishes how something breaks: *daa2 laan6* “smash into pieces”

But is English so different? *destroy*, *cut*, *cut off* , *cut out*, *cut through*, *sever*, ...

Coming and Going

- English *come* moves towards the speaker or the addressee
- Japanese *kuru*, Malay *datang* and Korean *oda* cannot shift the viewpoint that way

English *I'm coming!*
Japanese *Ima iki-masu!* "now go"

How Many Words for Rice?

How Many Words for Rice?

	English	Malay	Japanese	Cantonese
growing		*padi*	稲 *ine*	禾 *wo4*
raw	*rice*	*beras*	米 *kome*	米 *mai5*
cooked		*nasi*	ご飯 *gohan*	飯 *faan6*

How Many Words for Rice?

	English	Malay	Japanese	Cantonese
growing		*padi*	稲 *ine*	禾 *wo4*
raw	*rice*	*beras*	米 *kome*	米 *mai5*
cooked		*nasi*	ご飯 *gohan*	飯 *faan6*

Cooked rice often means “a meal”: Japanese *gohan*, Cantonese *sik6 faan6* “eat rice” “eat a meal”

Older and Younger Siblings

	English	Thai	Mandarin
older brother	*brother*	*phîi*	*gēge*
older sister	*sister*		*jiějie*
younger brother	*brother*	*nɔ́ɔŋ*	*dìdi*
younger sister	*sister*		*mèimei*

Relative age sets lifelong seniority in many Asian families

Birth Order in the Name

- Mandarin: “first brother”, “second brother”, ...
- Malay family nicknames: *long* “oldest”, ..., *teh* “fourth”
- Kin terms encode family roles, hierarchy and lineage

Feelings Live in the Body: Psycho-Collocations

	literally	means
Malay *panas hati*	hot liver	angry, worked up
Thai *thùuk-cay*	correct heart	please, satisfy
Lai *thin haaN*	liver become liquid	angry
English *hot-headed*	hot head	quick to anger

A body-part noun + adjective or verb (Matisoff, 1986); Thai, Malay and Lai have dozens: an **areal** feature of mainland Southeast Asia

Words for Nature and Seasons

- Words for weather, plants, insects and fish reflect traditional ways of life
- Japanese poetry has a whole class of **season words** (季語 *kigo*):

五月雨	*samidare*	early-summer rain
小春日和	*koharubiyori*	mild day in late autumn

Summary: Meaning Differs, Even for Basic Words

- Some words have **no equivalent**
- Even basic words **split or merge** meanings differently
- Kinship, rice and emotion words show what a culture **cares about**

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Cultural Key Words

- Words around which a culture **organizes** a whole domain
- Common, and turn up in proverbs and sayings
- Often have **no equivalent** elsewhere

English	*love*, *honesty*
Australian	*mate*
Japanese	*omiai*

Describing Them Without Bias

- English glosses smuggle in English concepts (**ethnocentrism**)
- Instead, explain with **semantic primes**: simple meanings found in every language (Wierzbicka, 1996)

SOMEONE THINK GOOD WANT BECAUSE

This **Natural Semantic Metalanguage** (NSM) can be checked against native speakers' intuitions

Malay *malu*

"shame", "shy", "embarrassed"

Aku malu.	"I'm ashamed."
Eh! Malu pulak dia!	"Oh, now they're shy!"

Fear that others will think or say something bad about you, so you keep away from them; it keeps people in line

Explication: *malu*

X feels *malu*

X feels something bad because X thinks like this:

people can know something about me
people can think something bad about me because of this
people can say something bad about me because of this
I don't want this

because X feels like this, X doesn't want to be near other people

it is good if people can feel something like this

Malay *sabar*

"patience", but broader: staying calm, enduring without losing control

Bersabar...	"Be patient..."
Sabar, jangan menangis.	"Calm down, don't cry."

Allah sentiasa bersama dengan orang-orang yang sabar
"Allah is always with those who are patient"

Explication: *sabar*

X is *sabar* [at the time]

at this time, X felt something bad

because of this, X could have thought:

I don't want this
I want to do something now

X did not think like this, because X didn't want to think like this

it is good if a person can be like this

Sabar takes inner discipline and self-control

Chinese 孝 *xiào*

filial piety: duty, respect and care for parents, alive or dead

百善孝为先 *bǎi shàn xiào wéi xiān*
"Of the hundred good deeds, *xiào* comes first"

父母恩比山高，比海深 *fùmǔ ēn bǐ shān gāo, bǐ hǎi shēn*
"What our parents give us is higher than a mountain,
deeper than the ocean"

Explication: 孝 *xiào* (1)

everyone can think about some other people like this:

- this person is my father, this person is my mother
- I exist because of them
- because of this when I think about them I feel something very good
- I cannot think about other people like this

it is good if a person thinks about these people at all times

- it is good if this person feels something because of this

Explication: 孝 *xiào* (2)

it is good if a person thinks about these people like this:

- I want them to feel something very good at all times
- because of this I have to do many good things for them
- I want to do these things
- I don't want these people to feel anything bad at any time
- because of this I cannot do some things
- I don't want to do these things

it is good if a person thinks like this about some people

- it is good if a person does many things because of this
- it is bad if a person doesn't think like this about some people

Chinese 忍 *rěn*

perseverance: enduring hardship without complaint, for a greater goal

忍气吞声 *rěn qì tūn shēng*

“endure one’s anger and swallow one’s voice”

Long-term goals over immediate desires; a source of inner strength

Explication: 忍 *rěn* (1)

everyone can think like this about some things:

I want these things to happen
I know they cannot happen if I don't do some things
I want to do these things because of this
if I have to do these things for a long time I don't want not to do them because of this
if I feel something bad when I do these things I don't want not to do them because of this

Explication: 忍 *rěn* (2)

it is good if a person always thinks like this

it is good if a person thinks about this when this person feels something bad

it is good if a person thinks about this when someone else does something bad to this person

it is good if a person does many things because this person thinks like this

it is good if a person can be like this

Japanese 甘え *amae*

dependence: taking someone's love and care for granted

"When I am with Y, nothing bad can happen to me"

Modelled on an infant's dependence on its mother; part of all close relationships in Japan

Explication: 甘え *amae*

X feels *amae* towards Y

X thinks like this about Y:

- when Y thinks about me, Y feels something good
- Y wants to do good things for me
- Y can do good things for me
- when I am with Y nothing bad can happen to me
- I don't have to do anything because of this
- I want to be with Y

X feels something good because of this

Japanese 思い遣り *omoiyari*

empathy: knowing what others need without being told
literally “think-give”

Omoiyari no aru ko ni natte ne.
“Please become a person with *omoiyari*.”

Omoiyari no kokoro o taisetsu ni shimashō.
“Let’s treasure the heart of *omoiyari*.”

Keeps harmony and avoids conflict

Explication: 思い遣り *omoiyari*

X has *omoiyari*

X often thinks like this about other people:

- I can know what this person feels
- I can know what this person wants
- I can do something good for this person because of this
- I want to do this
- this person doesn't have to say anything

because of this, X does something

people think this is good

Conclusions

- **Loans** map contact history: English, Malay and Japanese are built in layers
- Words are built by **compounding**, **reduplication** and **affixation**, in different mixes
- Languages **carve up meaning** differently, even for water, rice and siblings
- **Cultural key words** can be explained without bias in semantic primes

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